INCIDENT HANDLER'S JOURNAL

Entry 1 · Ransomware incident at a small U.S. primary-care clinic

Date	October 24, 2026	**Entry**	1
Description	A ransomware incident encrypted critical clinic files, including patient records, and interrupted normal business operations. Employees could not access required files and applications, and a ransom note demanded payment for a decryption key.	**Tools used**	No specific cybersecurity tools are identified in the scenario. The clinic shut down computer systems and contacted external organizations for technical assistance.

THE 5 W'S

Who caused the incident?	An organized cybercriminal group known for targeting healthcare and transportation organizations is described as responsible. The scenario does not identify the group by name.
What happened?	A ransomware attack encrypted important company files and displayed a ransom note demanding a large payment in exchange for a decryption key. Staff lost access to patient records and essential applications, disrupting clinic operations.
When did it happen?	The incident was reported on Tuesday at approximately 9:00 a.m. The exact calendar date and the time the attackers first gained access are not provided.
Where did it happen?	The incident affected the computer systems and network of a small U.S. clinic specializing in primary care. Multiple employees reported that they could not access files on their computers.
Why did it happen?	Targeted phishing emails containing malicious attachments gave the attackers an initial way into the network. When employees downloaded the attachments, malware was installed and the attackers deployed ransomware to encrypt critical files.

ADDITIONAL NOTES

The clinic should preserve relevant email, endpoint, and network logs; isolate affected devices from the network; and involve its incident-response and healthcare compliance teams. It should determine whether patient data was accessed or exfiltrated, validate clean backups before restoration, and avoid assuming that paying the ransom guarantees recovery. The scenario does not confirm data theft, the exact entry time, or whether tested backups are available.

Training scenario summary. Findings are limited to the facts provided; unconfirmed details are explicitly identified.